

Standard Operating Procedure

Automotive Parts Ordering Portal

Disclaimer

This is a sample Standard Operating Procedure document prepared for reference and review purposes only. The procedures should be validated and approved by the appropriate business, operational, legal, and compliance stakeholders before being used as final or official guidance.

Procedure Area	Purpose / Coverage
Order Placement	This procedure describes the steps required to place a spare parts order through the automotive parts ordering portal. It is intended for service partners, dealers, and workshop staff who are responsible for ordering parts on behalf of their organisation.
File Upload for Bulk Orders and Claims	This procedure describes how to use the file upload functionality in the automotive parts ordering portal to submit bulk orders or bulk claims using a CSV file. This feature is designed for users who need to order a large number of parts at once or submit multiple claims simultaneously, making it more efficient than entering each item individually through the standard order or claim screens.
Claim Submission	This procedure describes the steps required to submit a claim through the automotive parts ordering portal. Claims may be submitted for warranty failures, damaged deliveries, or quantity discrepancies. This procedure ensures that claims are submitted with all required information so that they can be processed efficiently and without unnecessary delays.
Return Processing	This procedure describes how service partners and dealers should process part returns through the automotive parts ordering portal. It covers both quarterly returns and yearly returns, which are scheduled return windows during which dealers can return eligible unsold or excess stock in exchange for a credit.

1. Order Placement

1.1 Purpose

This procedure describes the steps required to place a spare parts order through the automotive parts ordering portal. It is intended for service partners, dealers, and workshop staff who are responsible for ordering parts on behalf of their organisation.

1.2 Scope

This procedure applies to all standard spare parts orders placed through the online portal. It does not cover emergency or telephone orders, which are handled through a separate process.

1.3 Prerequisites

Before placing an order, the user must have an active account on the parts ordering portal with the appropriate ordering permissions. The user must also be connected to the network or have internet access to reach the portal. If the user is placing an order on behalf of a workshop, the correct workshop must be selected in the user profile before proceeding.

1.4 Procedure

The user begins by logging into the parts ordering portal using their assigned username and password. Upon successful login, the user is taken to the home screen which displays a summary of recent orders, any pending notifications, and quick access links to the main functional areas of the portal. To start a new order, the user navigates to the Order Input section from the main navigation menu. The Order Input screen presents a search interface where the user can look up parts by part number, part description, or vehicle model information. The user enters the known part number or description into the search field and initiates the search. The system returns a list of matching parts with details including the part number, description, unit of measure, available stock quantity, and current price. The user reviews the search results and selects the correct part by clicking on it. If the user is unsure whether a part is correct, they can view additional details such as technical specifications or compatibility information before adding it to the order. Once the correct part is confirmed, the user enters the required quantity in the quantity field. The system will display a warning if the requested quantity exceeds the available stock, in which case the user can choose to order the available quantity and accept a backlog for the remainder, or reduce the quantity to match available stock. After entering the quantity, the user clicks the button to add the part to the order basket. The user can continue searching for and adding additional parts to the same order. The order basket is visible on the screen and shows all parts added so far, along with a running total of the order value. Once all required parts have been added to the basket, the user reviews the complete order. At this stage the user should verify that all part numbers, quantities, and prices are correct. The user also confirms the delivery address, which defaults to the address registered against their account but can be changed if delivery to an alternative address is required. Before the order can be submitted, the system performs an automatic credit limit check. This check compares the total value of the current order against the available credit on the account. If the credit limit check passes, the user is presented with a final order confirmation screen showing all order details. The user clicks the confirm and submit button to place the order. The system processes the submission and displays a confirmation message containing the unique order reference number. This reference number should be noted as it will be needed for any future enquiries or tracking related to this order. If the credit limit check fails, the system displays a notification explaining that the order cannot be submitted due to insufficient credit. In this situation the user should contact their account manager to discuss credit limit options, or reduce the order to a value within the available credit.

1.5 Post-Order Actions

After placing the order, the user can immediately view the order in the Order Tracking section of the portal. The initial status of a newly placed order will indicate that it has been received and is awaiting processing. The user should monitor the order status regularly and take note of any updates or notifications from the warehouse team. If the user realises they have made an error in the order shortly after submission, they should contact the parts ordering support team immediately, as orders can only be amended or cancelled before they enter the picking process at the warehouse.

1.6 Common Issues

If the search returns no results for a part number, the user should verify that the part number has been entered correctly, including any hyphens or special characters. If the part number is confirmed correct but still returns no results, it is possible that the part has been superseded by a newer version, in which case the user should search by description or contact the technical support team for assistance. If the portal is slow or unresponsive during order submission, the user should wait a few moments before attempting to resubmit. The user should not click the submit button multiple times as this may result in duplicate orders being placed.

2. File Upload for Bulk Orders and Claims

2.1 Purpose

This procedure describes how to use the file upload functionality in the automotive parts ordering portal to submit bulk orders or bulk claims using a CSV file. This feature is designed for users who need to order a large number of parts at once or submit multiple claims simultaneously, making it more efficient than entering each item individually through the standard order or claim screens.

2.2 Scope

This procedure applies to the bulk order upload and bulk claim upload features available in the portal. It covers the preparation of the CSV file, the upload process, error handling, and confirmation steps.

2.3 Prerequisites

The user must have an active portal account with file upload permissions. Not all user roles have access to the bulk upload feature, so the user should confirm with their administrator that this permission is enabled on their account. The user must also have access to a spreadsheet application such as Microsoft Excel or a text editor to prepare the CSV file.

2.4 Preparing the CSV File for Bulk Orders

The CSV file for bulk orders must follow a specific format for the system to process it correctly. The file must contain a header row as the first line, followed by one data row for each part being ordered. The required columns are part number, quantity, and optionally a customer reference or note for each line item. The part number must be entered exactly as it appears in the parts catalog, including any hyphens or special characters. Spaces before or after the part number will cause the line to be rejected. The quantity must be a whole number greater than zero. Decimal quantities are not accepted. If a customer reference is included, it should not contain commas as this will break the CSV format. If the reference needs to contain a comma, the entire field should be enclosed in double quotation marks. The file must be saved in CSV format with UTF-8 encoding. Files saved in other formats such as XLSX or ODS will not be accepted by the upload function. The file size must not exceed the maximum allowed size displayed on the upload screen. If the file is too large, the user should split it into multiple smaller files and upload them separately.

2.5 Uploading a Bulk Order File

The user logs into the portal and navigates to the Order Input section. On the Order Input screen, the user selects the file upload option rather than the manual search option. The upload screen displays the required file format and a template file that the user can download as a starting point. The user clicks the browse or choose file button and selects the prepared CSV file from their computer. Once the file is selected, the user clicks the upload button. The system reads the file and performs a validation check on each row. If any rows contain errors, the system displays a list of the errors with the row number and a description of the problem. Common errors include unrecognised part numbers, invalid quantities, and formatting issues. The user must correct all errors in the CSV file and re-upload it before the order can be submitted. The system does not allow partial submission of a file with errors. Once the file passes validation, the system displays a preview of all the order lines with part details, available stock, and pricing. The user reviews this preview to confirm that everything is correct. If the total order value exceeds the available credit limit, the system will display a warning at this stage. The user then confirms the order and the system processes the submission, assigning a single order reference number to the entire bulk order.

2.6 Preparing the CSV File for Bulk Claims

The CSV file for bulk claims follows a similar structure to the bulk order file but requires different fields. The required columns are the original order or invoice reference number, the part number, the quantity being claimed, the claim type, and a brief description of the reason for the claim. The claim type field must contain one of the accepted values which are listed in the template file available on the upload screen. The description field should be concise but informative. If a more detailed description is needed for a specific claim line, the user should submit that claim individually through the standard claim submission screen rather than through the bulk upload.

2.7 Uploading a Bulk Claim File

The user navigates to the Claim Declaration section and selects the file upload option. The process for uploading and validating the file is the same as for bulk orders. The system validates each claim line against the purchase history to confirm that the referenced order exists and that the claimed quantity does not exceed the purchased quantity. Any lines that fail validation are listed with an explanation, and the user must correct these before resubmitting. Once the file passes validation, the system displays a preview of all claim lines. The user reviews and confirms the submission. The system assigns individual claim reference numbers to each line in the bulk submission, and all of these reference numbers are displayed on the confirmation screen. The user should save or print this confirmation for their records.

2.8 Downloading the Template File

Both the bulk order and bulk claim upload screens provide a downloadable template CSV file. This template contains the correct column headers and an example data row to guide the user in preparing their file. It is strongly recommended to use this template rather than creating a file from scratch, as it ensures the column order and formatting are correct.

2.9 Common Issues

If the system reports that a part number is not recognised, the user should verify the part number in the parts catalog before re-uploading. If the part number is correct but still not recognised, it may have been superseded or discontinued, in which case the user should contact the support team. If the upload button does not respond after selecting a file, the user should check that the file is in CSV format and that it does not exceed the maximum file size. Refreshing the page and trying again may also resolve temporary issues. If the system accepts the file but the order or claim does not appear in the tracking section after a few minutes, the user should contact the support team with the confirmation reference shown on the upload screen.

3. Claim Submission

3.1 Purpose

This procedure describes the steps required to submit a claim through the automotive parts ordering portal. Claims may be submitted for warranty failures, damaged deliveries, or quantity discrepancies. This procedure ensures that claims are submitted with all required information so that they can be processed efficiently and without unnecessary delays.

3.2 Scope

This procedure applies to all claim types available through the portal including warranty claims, damage claims, and quantity discrepancy claims. Quarterly and yearly return claims are covered in a separate procedure.

3.3 Prerequisites

The user must have an active portal account with claim submission permissions. To submit a claim, the user must have the original order or delivery reference number available, along with the part number and quantity being claimed. For warranty claims, the user should also have the date of installation and a description of the failure. For damage claims, photographic evidence of the damage should be prepared before starting the submission process.

3.4 Procedure for Warranty Claim Submission

The user logs into the portal and navigates to the Claim Declaration section from the main menu. On the Claim Declaration screen, the user selects the option to create a new claim and then selects the claim type as warranty claim. The user enters the original purchase order number or invoice number associated with the part being claimed. The system retrieves the order details and displays the parts included in that order. The user selects the specific part for which the claim is being raised and enters the quantity being claimed. The quantity claimed cannot exceed the quantity originally purchased. The user then enters the date on which the part was installed and the date on which the failure was observed. The system uses these dates to verify that the claim falls within the applicable warranty period. If the failure date is outside the warranty period, the system will display a warning, though the user may still submit the claim with an explanation if they believe there are exceptional circumstances. In the failure description field, the user provides a clear and detailed description of how the part failed. This description should include the symptoms observed, any diagnostic codes recorded, and the conditions under which the failure occurred. A thorough failure description significantly improves the chances of the claim being approved without the need for additional information requests. If supporting documents are required, the user uploads them using the document attachment function on the claim form. Supported file formats include PDF, JPEG, and PNG. Each attachment should be clearly named to indicate its content, for example job card, failure photo, or diagnostic report. Once all fields have been completed and documents attached, the user reviews the claim summary and clicks the submit button. The system assigns a unique claim reference number and displays a confirmation message. The user should note this reference number for future tracking.

3.5 Procedure for Damage Claim Submission

The user navigates to the Claim Declaration section and selects damage claim as the claim type. The user enters the delivery reference number from the delivery note received with the shipment. The system retrieves the delivery details and the user selects the damaged part or parts from the list. The user enters the quantity of damaged items and provides a description of the damage observed. The description should be specific, for example describing whether the damage is to the packaging only or to the part itself, and whether the part is unusable as a result. The user uploads photographic evidence of the damage. At minimum, photographs of the damaged packaging and the damaged part should be provided. The user submits the claim and notes the assigned claim reference number.

3.6 Procedure for Quantity Discrepancy Claim Submission

The user navigates to the Claim Declaration section and selects quantity discrepancy as the claim type. The user enters the delivery reference number and the system retrieves the delivery details. The user identifies the part or parts where the quantity received differs from the quantity on the delivery note. For each affected part, the user enters the quantity shown on the delivery note and the quantity actually received. The user provides a brief description of the discrepancy and submits the claim.

3.7 After Submission

After submitting any type of claim, the user can monitor its progress through the Claim Tracking section of the portal. The system will send notifications if the claims team requires additional information. The user should respond to any such requests promptly to avoid delays in processing. The target processing time for standard claims is stated in the service level agreement applicable to the dealer's contract.

3.8 Common Issues

If the system does not find an order when the order reference number is entered, the user should check that the reference number has been entered correctly. It is also possible that the order was placed under a different account, in which case the user should contact the support team. If the submit button is greyed out and cannot be clicked, it usually means that one or more required fields have not been completed. The user should scroll through the form to identify any fields marked as mandatory that have not been filled in.

4. Return Processing

4.1 Purpose

This procedure describes how service partners and dealers should process part returns through the automotive parts ordering portal. It covers both quarterly returns and yearly returns, which are scheduled return windows during which dealers can return eligible unsold or excess stock in exchange for a credit.

4.2 Scope

This procedure applies to all scheduled return processes available through the portal. It does not cover returns of damaged or defective parts, which are handled through the claim submission procedure.

4.3 Prerequisites

The user must have an active portal account with return submission permissions. Returns can only be submitted during the designated return window, which is communicated to dealers in advance via notification in the portal and by email. The user should have a clear understanding of which parts in their stock are eligible for return before beginning the process. Parts must be in their original, undamaged packaging and must not have been installed or used in any way.

4.4 Understanding Return Eligibility

Not all parts are eligible for return. Eligibility is determined by several factors including the part category, the age of the purchase, and the dealer's purchase volume during the relevant period. Certain part categories such as electrical components, consumables, and special order parts are typically excluded from the return program. The portal will only display parts that are eligible for return based on the dealer's purchase history, so parts that do not appear in the return selection screen are not eligible. The maximum return value is calculated as a percentage of the dealer's net purchases during the relevant period. This percentage is defined in the dealer's contract and may vary between dealers. The portal displays the maximum returnable value at the top of the return submission screen so the dealer can plan their return accordingly.

4.5 Procedure for Quarterly Return Submission

The user logs into the portal and navigates to the Claim section from the main menu. Within the Claim section, the user selects the Quarterly Return option. The system displays the current return window dates and the dealer's maximum returnable value for the current quarter. The user is presented with a list of eligible parts based on their purchase history from the previous quarter. For each part the user wishes to return, they enter the quantity to be returned. The quantity entered cannot exceed the quantity originally purchased and must not exceed the quantity physically available in the dealer's stock. As the user enters return quantities, the system calculates the running total value of the return and compares it against the maximum returnable value. If the total exceeds the maximum, the system will display a warning and prevent submission until the quantities are adjusted. Once the user has selected all parts to be returned and the total is within the allowed limit, the user reviews the return summary. The summary shows each part number, description, return quantity, unit price, and total value. The user confirms that the information is correct and submits the return request. Upon submission, the system generates a return authorisation document which the user can download and print. This document must be included with the physical return shipment. The system also displays the return shipping instructions, including the address to which the parts should be sent and any specific packaging requirements. The user is responsible for arranging the return shipment within the timeframe specified in the return authorisation document. Parts received after the deadline may not be accepted. Once the returned parts are received at the warehouse and inspected, a credit note is issued to the dealer's account. The credit note will be visible in the billing section of the portal.

4.6 Procedure for Yearly Return Submission

The yearly return process follows the same steps as the quarterly return process. The user navigates to the Claim section and selects the Yearly Return option. The system displays the yearly return window dates and the maximum returnable value for the year. The user selects eligible parts, enters return quantities, reviews the summary, and submits the return request. The key differences between quarterly and yearly returns are that the yearly return window is typically longer, the maximum returnable value may be higher, and the list of eligible parts may include items from a longer purchase history period. Some part categories that are excluded from quarterly returns may be eligible for yearly returns, and vice versa. The specific rules are defined in the dealer contract and are reflected in what the system displays as eligible.

4.7 Physical Return Shipment

After submitting a return request through the portal, the dealer must physically ship the parts back to the designated warehouse. All parts must be securely packaged to prevent damage during transit. The return authorisation document must be clearly visible on the outside of the shipment or included inside the top of the box. Each part should be in its original packaging with the part number clearly visible. Parts that arrive without a valid return authorisation, in damaged packaging, or with missing part number labels may be rejected and returned to the dealer at their expense.

4.8 Monitoring Return Status

The dealer can monitor the status of a submitted return through the Claim Tracking section of the portal. The status will update as the return progresses through the process, from submitted, to shipment received, to inspection complete, to credit issued. If there are any issues with the returned parts, such as parts found to be ineligible or damaged on arrival, the dealer will be notified through the portal and the credit will be adjusted accordingly.

4.9 Common Issues

If the quarterly or yearly return option is not visible in the portal, it is likely that the return window is not currently open. The user should check the portal notifications or contact their account manager to confirm the return window dates. If a part that the dealer believes should be eligible does not appear in the return selection list, the user should contact the support team. It is possible that the part falls into an excluded category or that the purchase was made outside the eligible period. If the maximum returnable value shown in the portal appears incorrect, the user should contact their account manager to verify the calculation, as it is based on the net purchase volume recorded in the system.